



The First Half Term

Seven weeks with a Year 10 form, in order. They have had a tutor before, so none of this is an icebreaker. It is resetting the routines for the year the work gets heavier, and noticing in September rather than in February who is going to slip.

Year 10 and 11. Year 10 is the forgotten year: new subjects, new expectations and a step up from Year 9 that nobody warned them about. Almost everything written for this key stage is really written for Year 11, so this half term is the part that is missing.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The seven weeks. What happens in each one, and what it is setting up.
Page 3	Print once. Everything the seven weeks needs, in the order you need it.
Page 4	The five routines, and the sheet you fill in as the half term goes.

Four things worth knowing first

	Why
They are not new, but the year is	They know how a form works. What they do not know is that the volume has changed, and that the habits which carried them through Year 9 will not carry them through this.
Attendance shows in week four	The pattern is visible by the fourth week and nobody acts on it until the spring. Week four here is for looking, and for one quiet word with the two you already suspect.
Praise stops at Year 10	It gets rarer every year, and this is the year it stops entirely, unless somebody keeps a stack of postcards in a drawer.
Finish what you started	Everything begun in week one is closed in week seven, because this is the year group that has learned to expect the opposite.

By half term the aim is not that they like each other. It is that the morning runs itself, and that you know which three you have not really spoken to.





The seven weeks

Year 10 and 11. One new thing a week, and everything started in week one is closed in week seven.

Week	What happens	What it is setting up
Week 1	The Register Reply from day one, with the Year 10 and 11 questions. Start By Half Term the same week: one sheet each, begun now and closed in week seven.	That this form has a way of starting, and that it is not Year 9's.
Week 2	The Opinion Line, with the Year 10 and 11 statements. Five minutes, and the first argument of the year happens somewhere it is allowed.	That opinions get said out loud here rather than only in a group chat.
Week 3	Today I Will, every morning. At this age the answer is usually a revision hour. Ask two people about yesterday's before you start.	That you follow things up, which is the only thing that makes it work.
Week 4	Attendance. The Check-In Record Sheet, amber for anybody you have not really seen, and one quiet word with the two you are worried about.	That being missing is noticed in September rather than in February.
Week 5	The Week Sheet, five minutes on a Monday. Not revision yet: a week that has a shape, and a spare slot in it for when the week goes wrong.	That planning is an ordinary Monday thing rather than something you start in March.
Week 6	Your one-to-one round, with The Quiet Word. Praise Postcards go in the drawer the same week.	That a quiet word is normal, and that somebody here notices when it goes well.
Week 7	By Half Term, closed. Then whatever slipped, once each, and a look at the attendance you flagged in week four.	That things get finished, and that week four was not for nothing.

If your school runs a whole-school induction in the first week, start this in week two and let it finish the half term. The order matters more than the dates.





Print once

Everything the seven weeks asks for, in the order it is needed, so the trip to the photocopier happens once. All of it is free on thepastoralguide.com.

What	When you need it	How many
The Register Reply	From day one	One sheet, for you
By Half Term	Week one, closed in week seven	One per student
The Opinion Line	Week two	The Year 10 and 11 set, one copy
Check-In Record Sheet	Week four, then weekly	One, or use the spreadsheet
The Quiet Word	Week four and week six	One for you, and cut the lanyard card out
The Week Sheet	Mondays from week five	One per student per week, or print a term
Praise Postcards	In the drawer from week six	A stack of twenty
Tell Me Later	On the wall from week one	A stack of slips, and a box
Conversation Starters	In the drawer	One set of cards, cut once

Tick them off as they come out of the printer. Everything on this list is print once and keep, apart from the sheets that say one per student.





The five routines

What should be running without you by half term, how each one is set, and the thing that tells you it has stuck.

The routine	How it is set	How you know it has stuck
Coming in	Same start every morning, and the register begins on time whether or not the room is ready. Year 10 will test this in the second week.	They are sitting down before you have asked.
The register	The Register Reply with the Year 10 and 11 questions, changing daily. It costs nothing because the register happens anyway.	Somebody complains when you skip it.
Monday	The Week Sheet, five minutes, every Monday from week five, and one minute on the next Monday to see what moved.	They bring last week's without being asked.
The quiet word	One or two a week from week four, in the same place each time, five minutes, finishing on a named day.	The ones you did not pick start asking.
Noticing	The Check-In Record Sheet on a Friday, amber for anybody you have not really spoken to this fortnight.	Nobody reaches half term still white on the sheet.

As you go

Week	What you set up	What did not stick
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

